

Intervals

An interval is the musical term for the distance between two notes on the keyboard and on the staff. Intervals are defined by their number and quality.

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Simple intervals of the major scale

The simple intervals of the major scale are called unison, second, third, fourth, fifth, sixth, seventh, and octave. The number of the interval is determined by the number of notes between the starting note and the top note, including the starting note and top note itself.

▽ C major scale

The keyboard below shows the intervals between Middle C and the other notes of the C major scale. Going up the scale, the intervals rise from unison, through second, third, fourth, fifth, sixth, and seventh, to one octave.

The interval from C to G spans five notes, so it is called a fifth.

